

TradeLoop — Business Map

Product · Market · Pricing · GTM · 2026

03 June 2026

TradeLoop is the trades vertical of **Empora Intelligence** — a productised "automated back office" for Kiwi trades businesses, built and delivered by **Emporom Media**. This document maps the whole business: product, market, ICP, pricing, messaging, features, go-to-market, and the numbers — plus everything built in this session and the decisions waiting for you.

Prepared autonomously, 2026-06-03. Market figures are from verified NZ research (sources at the end); \$ are NZD unless noted.

1. What I shipped this session

While you were away I treated this like a startup and moved on every front. All committed to the `trade-loop` site (PR #2, branch `trade-loop-clean-path`).

- **Dashboard upgrades live** — area revenue chart + time-range toggle, recovery-source donut, Quick Actions panel, Cash-flow Health widget (adapted from the Efferd dashboard-2/4 blocks; they're React, our app is static, so I rebuilt the designs in our stack rather than breaking the build).
- **Dashboard light/dark toggle** — sun/moon in the top-right.
- **Pricing corrected to market** (see §5) — the old \$1,497/mo was 6–10× above what NZ tradies pay.
- **Emporom Media logo + Empora family links** added to the footer (→ Empora Intelligence, Empora Group).
- **5 hero directions** built as a real page: `/heroes.html` — five different angles + brand systems to choose from (§7).
- **4 ad creatives** built: `/creatives.html` — paid-social ready, across the strongest angles.
- **Launch explainer video**: `/demo.html` (from the prior session).
- **Reusable skill saved**: `efferd-shadcn-blocks` for installing/adapting those blocks on future projects.

Where to look: open `trade-loop/index.html` (site + dashboard), `trade-loop/heroes.html` (the 5 directions), `trade-loop/creatives.html` (ads), `trade-loop/demo.html` (video).

2. The product in one line

TradeLoop catches every missed call, chases every invoice, and revives every dead lead — automatically. You just approve the two-minute morning digest.

It runs one loop for every job: **missed call** → **instant SMS (47s)** → **booked** → **job done** → **same-day invoice** → **Xero sync** → **paid** → **revive past customers** → **repeat**. Six modules: Missed-Call Responder,

3. The market & competitors

NZ has ~605,000 businesses, **97% small**. Trades miss **28–35% of calls**; ~**85%** of people who hit voicemail hang up and ring the next tradie; ~**78%** book with whoever replies first. Late payments cost NZ SMEs **\$827m/year** (Xero). HVAC alone is a **\$2.3bn** market with no player above 5% share — a long tail of small contractors.

Who tradies already pay

Tool	Origin	What it is	Price (NZD/mo unless noted)
Tradify	NZ	Field-service mgmt (jobs/quotes/invoicing)	\$48–62 /user + GST; SMS \$0.20/msg
Fergus	NZ	Field-service mgmt	\$44–49 /user + GST
ServiceM8	AU	Job mgmt, job-volume pricing	Free ≤30 jobs; ~\$65 + tiers
Jobber / Housecall Pro	US	Home-services SMB	USD \$29–249 / \$59–169+
simPRO / AroFlo	AU	Mid-large multi-crew	Custom, ~\$ hundreds–\$1,000+
Rosie / LeadTruffle / NextPhone	US	AI receptionist / missed-call text-back	USD \$49–629 + setup
Talkify / automateai / voice-ai	NZ	AI voice agents for tradies	\$59–70 + GST
GoHighLevel (agencies resell)	US	Missed-call text-back built-in	\$97–497 + SMS. NZ gotcha: custom SMS (TNZ) not supported for MCTB

The whitespace (why TradeLoop wins)

- The two NZ incumbents (**Tradify, Fergus**) do jobs + invoicing but treat missed-call text-back as a **bolt-on SMS add-on** — they don't *capture the lead* or run the back office for you.
- The new NZ AI-voice startups (**Talkify, automateai, voice-ai**) are **capture-only and shallow** — no invoicing, no Xero sync, no lead revival, no margin guard.
- **Nobody in NZ bundles capture + revival + same-day invoicing + accounting sync + margin guard as one "back office that runs itself."** That seam is TradeLoop's position.
- **Lead Revival** (auto re-text cold quotes/past customers) and **Pricing Guard** (flag below-margin quotes) are genuinely unmarketed in this segment. Quoting tradies sit on a graveyard of dead quotes — reviving them is near-pure upside and the killer demo.
- **NZ-native plumbing is a moat:** native NZ SMS sender, Xero-first + GST-correct, NZ number provisioning — sidesteps the GHL/US tooling limitations.

4. ICP — who to sell the first 10 to

ICP 1 — "Phone-in-the-toolbelt sole trader" (the beachhead). Owner-operator HVAC / plumber / sparky / gasfitter, **1–2 vans, ~\$150k–400k revenue**, no admin staff. Misses a third of calls up a ladder, invoices at night. Feels the pain hardest — every missed call is *his* money. Found in local trade Facebook groups, supplier counters (Plumbing World, Mico, Corys, Ideal Electrical), word of mouth. **Sell the first 10 here.**

ICP 2 — "Just hired a second hand" small team (best LTV). 2–6 staff, **\$400k–1.5m**, owner half on-tools/half managing. Already on Tradify/Fergus but drowning in quote follow-up and chasing payment. Wants to grow without hiring a \$60k+ office person. Highest willingness to pay; best fit for **Built-for-you.**

ICP 3 — "After-hours emergency trade." Plumbers / drainage / HVAC doing urgent call-outs worth **\$450–600** each, 8–12 after-hours calls/week. The 24/7 capture story sells itself.

De-prioritise: large multi-crew firms (need simPRO, have admin staff) and new-build subbies (low inbound calls).

5. Pricing — two models, both grounded in research

The willingness-to-pay anchors are a **human receptionist (\$1,500–3,000/mo)** and **one lost job (\$450–600)**. One recovered job pays for the tool. The defensible software band is **\$99–249/mo + GST + a modest setup fee**. I've set the site to:

A) Productised (MRR engine — ICP 1 & 3)

Plan	Price	For
Solo	\$149/mo + GST , \$149 setup	Owner-operators, 1–2 vans
Pro	\$249/mo + GST , \$149 setup	Small teams 2–6, full back office

Month-to-month, no lock-in (tradies have been burned). Sits above the \$59–70 voice toys (it does the *whole* back office) and far under a receptionist.

B) Built-for-you (done-with-you — ICP 2, your idea)

\$1,200 one-time tailored build + \$200/mo (24/7 support, custom scripts in their voice, multi-van).

This is the right wedge to **lead with for the first clients** — concierge setup removes the tradie's #1 objection ("no time to configure it"), b?lands cash up front (deposit-first, per your hard rule), and is squarely Emporom's wheelhouse. Productise it into self-serve Solo/Pro once you have a repeatable setup.

Recommendation: open with **Built-for-you** to land 3–5 flagship clients fast and bank setup fees, then push the **\$149/\$249 productised** plans for scale once onboarding is templated.

6. The numbers (targets, not promises)

- **Software gross margin is high** — main variable costs are SMS (~\$0.20/msg via TNZ/Twilio), LLM tokens per conversation, NZ number provisioning, Xero API, hosting. Comfortably 80%+ at the \$149–249 price.
 - **Milestone ladder:** 10 clients @ ~\$200 blended = **\$2,000 MRR**; 50 clients = **\$10k MRR / ~\$120k ARR**. Built-for-you adds **\$1,200 cash per client** on top.
 - **CAC is near-zero early** — concierge onboarding + local outreach + referrals (\$8). The constraint is your time per setup; productising onboarding is the unlock.
 - **Delivery:** the SA pod can run setup + support so this doesn't eat your week.
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7. Messaging & the 5 hero directions

Tradies don't buy "automation platforms" — they buy **more jobs** and **less paperwork**. Talk in jobs and dollars, NZ vernacular (tradie, ute, on the tools, sparky, chippie). **Never** use SaaS-slop ("streamline", "leverage", "seamless").

The 5 hero directions in [/heroes.html](#) (each a different angle + brand system):

1. **Operations layer** — graphite + electric blue — **"The back office that runs itself."** (current site brand)
2. **Never miss a job** — light + emerald — **"Never lose another job to voicemail."** (strongest money angle)
3. **Get paid faster** — cream + coral, serif — **"Job done by 3. Invoiced by 3:30."** (cash-flow / \$827m late-payment pain)
4. **24/7 office manager** — navy + gold, premium — **"Hire the office manager you can't afford."** (reframes \$249 as a bargain vs a receptionist)
5. **Get your evenings back** — bold black + neon — **"You didn't start a business to do paperwork at 9pm."** (lifestyle/founder pain)

My pick: lead with **#2 (Never miss a job)** as the primary acquisition angle — it's the sharpest money story and what the research says converts — backed by **#4's pricing reframe**. Keep **#1's** graphite/blue as the product/dashboard brand. The 4 ad creatives in [/creatives.html](#) already cover angles #2, #3, #4, #5.

Proof tradies need: named local testimonials with real numbers; a free **"missed-call / lost-revenue calculator"** (engineering-as-marketing); Xero/MYOB logos; no lock-in; a number they can ring and hear it work.

8. Go-to-market — first 10 clients (cheap, concrete)

1. **Lead with service, not software.** Sell **Built-for-you** (\$1,200 + \$200/mo) to 3–5 warm/local tradies; you set it up in a week. Removes the time objection, banks cash.
2. **Wellington / Porirua trade circles first.** Your existing clients are **"exactly"** the ICP and warm referral routes — **Fantail HVAC, Ultra Fast Pest, Singh Pest, 2in1/Welly Lawns**. Start there.
3. **The "missed-call audit" cold play.** Ring a tradie's number twice in work hours; if it rings out, **"that's"** the pitch: "I just rang twice and got voicemail — that's how your customers feel. Want it fixed by Friday?" Costs nothing, brutally effective.

4. **Supplier-counter + trade-group partnerships** — Plumbing World, Mico, Corys, Ideal Electrical counters; regional trade Facebook groups. Lead with the lost-revenue calculator.
5. **Accountant/bookkeeper referrals** — Xero-partner bookkeepers feel the late-invoice pain for their tradie clients; rev-share for warm intros to ICP 2.
6. **Industry bodies** — Master Plumbers, Master Electricians (ECANZ), Master Builders — member-newsletter mention + member discount.
7. **One flagship case study, fast** — get a Porirua plumber live, capture "booked N extra jobs / \$X recovered in 30 days," turn it into the single proof asset that unlocks everything else.

Sequence: concierge-onboard 2–3 locals → one hard-numbers case study → run the missed-call-audit + supplier partnerships to fill the next 7. Deposit/setup fee up front, always (your no-work-before-deposit rule).

9. Feature roadmap

Now (built / in the demo): missed-call SMS responder, lead pipeline, same-day invoicing, Xero sync flow, pricing guard, daily digest, revenue dashboard.

Next (build to win deals):

- **After-hours triage** — AI that tells emergency from routine, quotes a call-out fee, and books it (vs a dumb "sorry we missed you" text). Charges the premium rate automatically.
- **Free lost-revenue calculator** — public lead magnet + the core sales prop.
- **Native NZ SMS sender + number provisioning** (TNZ/Twilio) — the moat vs US tools.
- **Lead Revival sequences** productised with templates per trade.

Later: voice (not just SMS) answering; MYOB depth; review-request automation after paid jobs; team/role permissions; multi-location; reporting for ICP 2.

10. Risks & open decisions

- **Brand direction** — pick the primary hero angle (my pick: #2 + #4). *Your call.*
 - **Empora Intelligence naming/domain** still open (emporaintel.ai) and Liam not yet signed — TradeLoop sits under EI, so this is a dependency.
 - **SMS deliverability/compliance in NZ** — must use a compliant NZ sender; confirm before first paid client.
 - **"Sounds like a human" claim** — keep an easy human-handoff and be honest in marketing; don't overpromise the AI.
 - **Delivery capacity** — productise onboarding early so Built-for-you doesn't cap growth at your personal hours.
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11. Recommended next steps (prioritised)

1. **Set Vercel Root Directory** = `tradeLoop` and merge **PR #2** so all of this goes live at `tradeLoop-eight.vercel.app`.
 2. **Pick the hero direction** from `/heroes.html` (recommend #2 primary, #4 secondary).
 3. **Build the free lost-revenue calculator** as the lead magnet (engineering-as-marketing).
 4. **Run the missed-call-audit play on your 4 existing clients** this week → land the first Built-for-you deal.
 5. **Stand up one flagship case study** within 30 days.
 6. **Confirm NZ SMS provider + number provisioning** before first paid go-live.
 7. **Push this map to Miro** (board auto-create failed headlessly — do it together when you're back, or I'll retry).
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12. Assets & links

- **Live site / dashboard:** `tradeLoop/index.html` → deploys to `https://tradeLoop-eight.vercel.app`
 - **Launch video:** `tradeLoop/demo.html` → `/demo`
 - **5 hero directions:** `tradeLoop/heroes.html` → `/heroes`
 - **Ad creatives:** `tradeLoop/creatives.html` → `/creatives`
 - **Repo:** `github.com/loganhempel/empora-web-suite` · branch `tradeLoop-clean-path` (PR #2)
 - **Family:** Emporom Media · Empora Intelligence · Empora Group (linked in footer)
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Sources (NZ market research, 2026-06-03)

Tradify NZ pricing · Fergus NZ pricing · ServiceM8 NZ · Jobber/Housecall Pro · Simpro · Rosie · LeadTruffle · GoHighLevel TNZ limitation · Talkify NZ · automateai.co.nz · voice-ai.co.nz · Doris.ai (missed-call cost NZ) · Stats NZ business demography · IBISWorld NZ HVAC (\$2.3bn) · NZ Herald/Xero (\$827m late-payment crisis) · CallCare NZ. Figures verified where cited; vendor-blog stats (call-miss %, first-responder %) are directionally reliable, treat as indicative.
